

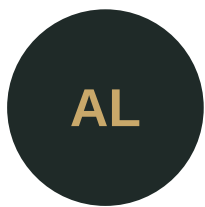
Three voices, one system.

Before you decompose anything, you listen. Here are three people who run Nordhem, each telling you where the business wants to go, and what stands in the way. They do not fully agree. Your job is to find the objectives hiding in the overlap.

How to use these transcripts

You are about to hear from three leaders at Nordhem: the CEO, the Chief Product Officer, and the VP of Engineering. Listen first. These pages carry the same words, so you can return to them once the recordings finish and mine them for detail.

Nobody in these recordings will hand you a clean list of objectives. The CEO speaks in ambition, the CPO in features and frustration, the VP of Engineering in constraints and hard truths. Each sees a different slice of the same reality, and some of what they say sits in tension with the others. That tension is not noise to be filtered out. It is exactly what a real listening tour sounds like, and the business objectives you need live precisely where these three accounts meet, pull apart, and quietly contradict one another.



Astrid Lindqvist

Chief Executive Officer

TRACK 1

► LISTEN, THEN READ

So, where do I want Nordhem to be in three years? Twice the size, honestly. We've proven the model in the Nordics, people love what we do, the brand means something. Germany and the Netherlands are the prize now, that market is enormous and nobody's serving the design-conscious middle the way we could. And B2B, the hotels and the interior designers, that could be a third of our revenue if we let it. Those buyers spend serious money and they come back every quarter.

What frustrates me? We're slow. I ask for something and it takes half a year. Our competitors ship things in weeks and we're still talking about it. I don't fully understand why, the team is good, but everything feels stuck in treacle. And every December I hold my breath, because if the site falls over on a peak weekend, that's not a bad day, that's the year.

I need us to be able to move fast and not be terrified of our own busiest season. That's it, really. Grow, move quickly, and stop being fragile when it matters most.



Tomas Berg

Chief Product Officer

TRACK 2

► LISTEN, THEN READ

My problem is simple to say and apparently impossible to solve. I have a roadmap the business is desperate for and I can't ship it fast enough.

Top of the list, B2B. Right now our business customers get a consumer checkout with a few bodes bolted on, no proper quotes, no negotiated pricing, no invoicing, no way to have three people from the same company on one account. It's embarrassing, and we're leaving money on the table every single day.

Second, mobile. We have no app. None. Our customers are on their phones and we're giving them a website from 2015. But every time we scope it, engineering tells me there's no clean way to get the data out, that the app would have to talk to the same tangled mess the website does.

And honestly, the thing that kills me is the small stuff. I ask for a new field on a product, a new step in checkout, and it's three months and four teams. I don't want to wait for the big transformation. I want to be able to change things in my part of the product without waiting for everybody else. If you fix one thing for me, make it that: let my teams move without stepping on each other.



Priya Rao

VP of Engineering

TRACK 3

► LISTEN, THEN READ

It's one system on one database, and that's why we're slow. But the coupling isn't the whole story. Half my best people spend their week keeping the lights on, not building anything. We have a shared library that every team piles into because that's how you get promoted here, be seen to have company-wide impact, so it's become this untouchable thing nobody dares change. That's not a technical problem I can refactor away. That's how we reward people.

And when Tomas says he wants his teams to move independently, I agree, but the teams aren't shaped for that. We're organised by layer, a frontend group, a backend group, the database people. Nobody owns a slice of the business end to end. So "move independently" means reorganising who works with whom, not just splitting code. That's harder, and it's not my decision alone to make.

On the database, the thing that scares me isn't just scale. It's that we genuinely don't know where all our customer data lives anymore. If a German regulator asks us to delete someone, today, I cannot confidently tell you we'd get all of it. We're expanding into the most privacy-strict market in the world with that hanging over us.

And here's the one nobody wants to hear. Some of what Tomas wants to build fast, and some of what we already lovingly maintain in-house, we shouldn't be building at all. Payments we were right to hand off. But we still run things ourselves that we could buy tomorrow, because the team enjoys building them. If we're serious about speed, we have to stop spending our best engineering on problems that aren't what makes Nordhem special. That's a harder conversation than any migration.

YOUR TASK

Now extract the objectives

You have done your listening tour. Three voices, three vantage points, one business. Working as an architecture team, turn what you heard into the north stars this modernisation will serve.

Where do the three agree? The objectives that all three voices point at, directly or indirectly, are the ones you can hold with confidence.

Where do they conflict? The CEO wants to grow fast; the VP says the foundation has to change first. The CPO wants to build more, sooner; the VP says some of it should not be built at all. These tensions do not disappear. Your objectives have to hold them honestly.

What was hiding inside a feature request? Listen again to what the CPO asked for last, and what the VP said it really means. Not every objective is stated as one.

Produce a short list of business objectives, in the business's own words, that the rest of today will hang off: the domains you find, the characteristics you prioritise, the roadmap you sequence.